

“All the News
That’s Fit to Print”

The New York Times

THE WEATHER
Today, morning sunshine, afternoon clouds, high 64. **Tonight**, a couple of showers, mainly late, low 48. **Tomorrow**, an early shower, mostly cloudy, high 59. Weather map, Page B12.

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Prices in Canada may be higher

\$4.00



TEHRAN Supporters of Ayatollah Mojtaba Khamenei. On Thursday, he issued a statement on issues stalling peace talks. Page A10.

Snag for Trump In Xi Meeting: Iran Blockade

By DAVID E. SANGER
and TYLER PAGER

President Trump's declaration that he is willing to maintain a blockade on Iranian shipping until the Iranians surrender to his demands almost assures that the Strait of Hormuz will remain closed by the time he arrives in Beijing in two weeks.

That is exactly what Mr. Trump was seeking to avoid when he delayed his trip to China six weeks ago. And it vastly complicates a critical meeting with President Xi Jinping, forcing White House officials to rethink how Mr. Trump approaches the effort to engineer a rapprochement with China.

In public and private, Mr. Xi has demanded that the United States reopen the waterway through which China imports about a third of its oil and gas.

When Mr. Trump initially envisioned the trip as the first in a series of carefully scripted meetings, the possibility of a war with Iran was not on the radar of most administration officials. When he delayed it in early April, he was confident the war would be over quickly.

At the time of that decision, members of Mr. Trump's national security team said they hoped that forcing Iran into a nuclear deal after a relatively short bombing campaign would be a demonstration of American power and reach. They also saw it as a warning to Beijing as Mr. Trump sought a rapprochement with the country that is America's largest military, technologic and economic competitor.

But that assumption, like so many about the course of the war with Iran, has now gone badly awry.

If Mr. Trump flies to China as planned, with an intensive, two-day visit starting on May 14, the primary topic will clearly be the rippling economic effects of a war that China has made clear it viewed as unnecessary. Mr. Xi went further recently, warning that the world may be returning to the “law of the jungle,” though he made no specific reference to Iran or the strait at that time.

More than a week ago the Chinese leader directly called for the reopening of the strait, telling Crown Prince Mohammed bin Salman of Saudi Arabia, according to Chinese state media, that it “should remain open to normal

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Are Attacks on Jewish Targets in Europe Linked?

By MEGAN SPECIA
and KOBA RYCKEWAERT

LONDON — Just before midnight on March 23, an empty car was set alight in the Jewish district of Antwerp, Belgium, breaking the quiet of the night.

The police quickly arrested two teenagers. Several hours later, blurry footage of the arson appeared online, showing one person pouring liquid on a car and a second person lighting it on fire.

In the video, a group that was unknown just a few months ago claims responsibility. The group, which calls itself Harakat Ashab al-Yamin al-Islamiyya, has also taken responsibility for a series of

Investigators Seek Ties to Distant Sources Like Iran

other attacks across Europe, including one on Wednesday in which two people were stabbed in a Jewish area of London.

Now, counterterrorism officials say they are investigating whether the group has ties to Iran — and whether these criminal acts are the latest iteration of asymmetrical warfare by Iran or another malign actor, all using low-cost, unsophisticated meth-

ods to sow fear in Jewish communities across Europe.

Those accused of carrying out the attacks did not appear to have allegiance to an extremist cause and were likely recruited to act with the promise of money, law enforcement authorities and lawyers say.

Chantal Van den Bosch, the lawyer for one of the teenagers charged in the Antwerp case, said in an interview that her client had “no idea” the arson would be filmed and shared online and that he had taken part to make “quick cash.”

“They’re basically cannon fodder. They’re being used,” she said.

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MATT MCCLAIN FOR THE NEW YORK TIMES

A day care in West Virginia. Deregulation efforts could make it tougher to find child care services.

Child Care Chief Seeks to Slash Costs and Rules

By CORAL DAVENPORT

WASHINGTON — When Alex Adams arrived in Washington late last year as the Trump administration's point man on child care, he was little known outside his home state of Idaho, where he had helped engineer a massive deregulation effort that became the envy of many conservative activists.

He made his intentions clear right away.

Federal child care regulations, he told his new staff, should “fit on an index card in my back pocket,”

Providers Fear a Decline in Quality and Safety

according to two people who heard him make the remark.

Now, five months into his job as head of the Administration for Children and Families, which controls about \$25 billion in child care and preschool funding for some 2.3 million poor children, Mr. Adams is preparing what he has said will be a “bonfire” of regulations.

Among his top targets: the most

sweeping overhaul in a generation for Head Start, which provides child care and preschool to hundreds of thousands of the nation's poorest children. Mr. Adams intends to loosen or eliminate the rules that limit how many children can be supervised by each teacher, according to three people familiar with the plans. Conservatives say the changes could give more poor children access to the service, yet many child care experts say they could jeopardize quality and safety. The alterations are expected to affect almost ev-

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Ruling on Map May Clog Pipeline of Black Leaders

Generation of Emerging Democrats in South Faces Steeper Task After Voting Case

By RICK ROJAS

ATLANTA — Evan Turnage left a job on Capitol Hill and returned home to Mississippi to run for Congress. It didn't pan out; he lost a Democratic primary in March against a popular incumbent. But by crisscrossing the region and building name recognition, he thought he had laid groundwork that could pay off later.

Next time, though, he could face an even more formidable hurdle: His district, long drawn to have a majority-Black constituency, could be redrawn to become practically impossible for a Black Democrat to win.

Across the South, Republican officials are ready to quickly redraw legislative districts, seizing upon the Supreme Court decision on Wednesday that struck down a voting map in Louisiana and further weakened the landmark Voting Rights Act, which for decades helped usher in generations of Black leaders. On Thursday, Louisiana's governor delayed the state's House primaries and asked legislators to draw a new map. [Page A15.]

Critics of the court's decision expect that any reconfiguration will not only endanger Black incumbents, some of whom have held office for decades, but also threaten a rising generation of Black Democrats in the South, who already have few avenues for ascending in politics.

“It's going to mean for a lot of people that they leave politics altogether, because there aren't districts that make sense,” said Mr. Turnage, 34, who ran in Mississippi's Second Congressional District, which is regarded as vulnerable to redistricting. “It's definitely going to be devastating.”

STUNNING RULING Civil rights movement veterans said the Supreme Court decision felt like a bleak end to decades of gains. PAGE A15

Putting Brakes To the Speeders Who Don't Stop

By STEFANOS CHEN

A small but persistent group of New York City drivers has racked up dozens, sometimes hundreds, of speeding tickets but continues to drive recklessly.

These drivers, whom safe-streets advocates refer to as “super-speeders,” make up less than 1 percent of drivers in the city. Studies show they are far more likely to cause serious car-crash injuries and deaths, especially near school zones.

A driver must be caught on camera speeding 16 or more times in a single year — or more than once a month — to qualify as a super-speeder. In New York City, that designation currently includes about 14,600 vehicles.

Now, Gov. Kathy Hochul is seeking to pass a bill that would require the drivers of those vehicles to install speed-limiting devices. Its fate is tied to state budget negotiations with the Legislature, which has so far failed to pass the measure.

The device, known as Intelligent Speed Assistance, is a small box affixed to the dashboard that uses GPS to identify the speed limit — 25 m.p.h. or less on most local streets, and higher on highways — and caps the driver slightly above it. The driver may temporarily override the device, in certain circumstances, with the tap of a button.

Proponents say the program could lead to a big improvement in

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ALEX KENT FOR THE NEW YORK TIMES

Dr. Casey Means has been a favorite with MAHA voters.

Trump Gives Up On His Choice For Top Doctor

By SHERYL GAY STOLBERG
and DANI BLUM

WASHINGTON — President Trump has withdrawn the nomination of Dr. Casey Means, his pick for surgeon general, whose confirmation was stalled amid opposition, including from some Republicans, over her views on vaccines and her unconventional approach to medicine.

In a social media post on Thursday, Mr. Trump announced a new nominee: Dr. Nicole B. Saphier, a radiologist who has a wellness podcast and has appeared frequently on Fox News. She is the director of breast imaging at MSK Monmouth in New Jersey, a branch of Memorial Sloan Kettering Cancer Center in Manhattan.

Mr. Trump described Dr. Saphier as “a STAR physician who has spent her career guiding women facing breast cancer” and

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INTERNATIONAL A4-11

Symbol of Colonial Plunder

Mayor Zohran Mamdani of New York suggested that Britain should return one of its crown jewels. PAGE A6

Seniors Await A.I. Callers

In South Korea, the world's fastest-aging society, bots make care calls to people struggling with dementia. PAGE A4

NATIONAL A12-21

Homeland Security Bill Passed

House Republicans were forced to use a special maneuver to steer around opposition in their own party, relying on Democrats to push it through. PAGE A16

Mills Bows Out in Maine

Janet Mills's withdrawal from the Senate race reflects the energy of the Democratic Party's left and voters' unease with older candidates. PAGE A13

A New Worry for Republicans

President Trump made major inroads with Hispanics in 2024. But Latino Catholic voters now express dismay at his feud with the pope. PAGE A12



BUSINESS B1-7

Countries Stocking Up on Gold

As risk has escalated, amid a widening war, central banks have bought more of the ore to stash in reserve. PAGE B1

A.I. Spending Sets a Record

Google, Amazon, Microsoft and Meta have reported more than \$130 billion in quarterly capital expenditures. PAGE B1

SPORTS B8-11

Left Behind in Louisville

Exorbitant ticket prices and the decision of Churchill Downs to change the post time of the Kentucky Oaks have locals feeling as if the Kentucky Derby isn't theirs anymore. PAGE B8

A Plan to End Tanking

The N.B.A. has a problem with teams not playing hard at the end of the season to improve their chances in the draft lottery. A new proposed reform could help fix that. PAGE B11

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The Editorial Board

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WEEKEND ARTS C1-10

Neighborhood Fixtures

The sphinxes and columns in Lauren Halsey's sculpture park in South Central Los Angeles pay homage to some familiar local residents. PAGE C1

